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# The Ecumenical Potential of Pneumatology

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# The Ecumenical Potential of Pneumatology<sup>1</sup>

## *Introduction: The Ecumenical Renaissance of Pneumatology*

The last two decades or so in ecumenical theology have been the golden age of “ecumenical models”: “organic unity”, “concord unity”, “conciliar unity”, “unity in reconciled diversity” etc.<sup>2</sup> Overall, there has been a radical scaling down of what unity implies. After the proposal of Oscar Cullmann of unity through diversity in which the New Testament metaphor of the members of the body is taken out of the context of the local congregation and applied to present denominations,<sup>3</sup> we have heard of expressions like “ecumenism in oppositions” (*Ökumene in Gegensätzen*)<sup>4</sup>, and, most paradoxical of all, “ecumenism without unity.”<sup>5</sup> The last decade has witnessed the rise to prominence of *koinonia*-theology, and it is yet to be seen what are its long-term ecumenical implications.<sup>6</sup>

This article reflects on yet another perspective on Christian unity, that of pneumatology. I hesitate to call the pneumatological perspective

<sup>1</sup> I am indebted to KILIAN McDONNELL, O.S.B., the President of the Institute for Ecumenical and Cultural Research, Collegeville, MN, for his review of this essay. His extensive writings on pneumatology and his mentorship have considerably inspired and shaped my theological thinking about the relation of the Spirit and Christian unity. Dr. Patrick Henry, the Executive Director of the Institute proofread my article and corrected the language.

<sup>2</sup> A succinct introduction to ecumenical models and ways of unity is offered by THOMAS BEST, “Models of Unity,” and “Ways to Unity”, in *Dictionary of the Ecumenical Movement*, ed. NICHOLAS LOSSKY et. al. (WCC Publications, Geneva, 1991), pp. 1041-1043, 1043-1047 respectively.

<sup>3</sup> OSCAR CULLMANN, *Einheit durch Vielfalt* (Tübingen: Mohr, 1986).

<sup>4</sup> ERICH GELDBACH, *Ökumene in Gegensätzen*. Bemsheimer Heft 66 (Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1987); LAURENTIUS KLEIN, “Theologische Alternative zur Konsensusökumene,” *Theologische Quartalschrift* 166:4, 1986, pp. 268-278.

<sup>5</sup> E. LE COUTRE, “Ökumene ohne Einheit,” *Der Ueberblick* 24:3, 1988. Reformed ecumenist HENRY I. LEDERLE of South Africa (“The Spirit of Unity: A Discomforting Comforter. Some Reflections on the Holy Spirit, Ecumenism and the Pentecostal-Charismatic Movements,” *The Ecumenical Review* 42:3-4, 1990, p. 291) calls this model the “cheapest,” without any meaning.

<sup>6</sup> The literature on *koinonia*, easily accessible, is too vast to be introduced in the space of a short article.

another “model”, because that term limits too severely the doctrine and spirituality of the Spirit of God.

Ecumenical theology in the past, has not paid much attention to the role of the Spirit. Konrad Raiser of WCC has noted that what is most characteristic of ecumenical thought is its *dialogical* nature; it has taken shape in response to challenges both from within and outside the ecumenical movement. Genuine dialogue does not aim at comprehensiveness; it can leave things open or unsaid, to be taken up at a later stage. Dialogue is moved forward by what the respective partners perceive to be the most pressing issues at a given time, allowing for later reformulation of earlier insights once a new challenge arises. The doctrine of the Holy Spirit is a case in point. For a long time, the need did not seem to be felt in the ecumenical movement to enter more fully into a discussion of pneumatology.<sup>7</sup>

Now things have changed completely. There is resurgence of pneumatology in every theological corner. At least two major developments in the Christian *oikumene* have contributed to it. First is the entrance of Eastern Orthodox Churches into the WCC-constituency in the 1960's. The second is the emergence and phenomenal growth of Pentecostalism, and later Charismatic Movements in the historic churches.

Kilian McDonnell, O.S.B., one of the foremost developers of pneumatology in our time, issued already in 1985 a programmatic statement, in which he quoted Karl Barth:

Everything that one believes, reflects and says about God the Father and God the Son... would be demonstrated and clarified basically through God the Holy Spirit, the *vinculum pacis*, between Father and Son. The work of God in behalf of creatures for, in, and with humanity would be made clear in a teleology which excludes all happenstance.<sup>8</sup>

Times are gone when it was commonplace to say that the Holy Spirit is the Cinderella of the Trinity; when the other two sisters went to the theological ball, the Holy Spirit got left behind every time.<sup>9</sup> “But

<sup>7</sup> KONRAD RAISER, “The Holy Spirit in Modern Ecumenical Thought,” *The Ecumenical Review* 41:3, 1989, p. 375.

<sup>8</sup> KILIAN McDONNELL, “A Trinitarian Theology of the Holy Spirit?” *Theological Studies* 46, 1985, p. 193, quoting Karl Barth, *Schleiermacher-Auswahl mit einem Nachwort von Karl Barth*, ed. Heinz Bolli (Munich: Siebenstern-Taschenbuch, 1968), p. 311.

<sup>9</sup> Both ALISTAIR MCGRATH (*Christian Theology. An Introduction* [Oxford UK & Cambridge USA: Blackwell, 1994], p. 240) and JÜRGEN MOLTMANN (*The Spirit of Life: A Universal Affirmation*, trans. M. Kohl [London: SCM Press, 1992], p. 1) use this striking illustration.

not now. The rise of the charismatic movement within virtually every mainstream church has ensured that the Holy Spirit figures prominently on the theological agenda. A new experience of the reality and power of the Spirit has had a major impact upon the theological discussion of the person and work of the Holy Spirit."<sup>10</sup> The rise of the Pentecostal movement, and later Charismatic Movements, have challenged the mainline churches and theologies to rethink their attitude toward NT-type of enthusiastic, charismatic spirituality and theologizing. Nowadays it will not do to speak about the Holy Spirit as the *theos agraptos* — God about whom no one writes (Gregory of Nazianzus in the fourth century)<sup>11</sup> or as “the forgotten God” (Catholic theologians of the nineteenth century)<sup>12</sup>.

Nikolay Berdayev called the theology of the Spirit “the last unexplored theological frontier”,<sup>13</sup> and Karl Barth called it “the future of Christian theology.”<sup>14</sup> As the challenge to develop truly trinitarian, ecumenically sound, in that sense catholic, pneumatology has now been taken up, the result is a vast and growing literary output.<sup>15</sup>

### *Eastern Orthodox Pneumatology in the Forefront*

The doctrine of the Spirit has always played a more prominent role in Eastern Orthodox theology than in the West, with roots in the classical works of Athanasius, Cyril of Alexandria, and Basil the Great.

<sup>10</sup> MCGRATH, *Christian Theology*, p. 240; see also Thomas C. ODEN, *Life in the Spirit. Systematic Theology*, vol. 3 (San Francisco: Harper Collins, 1992), p. 3.

<sup>11</sup> DONALD J. GELPI, “The Theological Challenge of Charismatic Spirituality,” *PNEUMA: The Journal of the Society for Pentecostal Studies* 14:2, 1992, p. 185.

<sup>12</sup> GELPI, “The Theological Challenge,” p. 185.

<sup>13</sup> NIKOLAY BERDYAEV, *Spirit and Reality* (London: Bles, 1964), p. 22.

<sup>14</sup> Quoted in PAUL D. LEE, *Pneumatological Ecclesiology in Roman Catholic-Pentecostal Dialogue. A Catholic Reading of the Third Quinquennium* (1985-1989). Dissertatio Ad Lauream in Facultate S. Theologiae Apud Pontificiam Universitatem S. Thomae in Urbe (Rome, 1994), p. 200. cf. McDONNELL, “A Trinitarian Theology,” pp. 191, 193.

<sup>15</sup> For a quick survey, see the massive collection *Credo in Spiritum Sanctum: Atti del Congresso Teologico Internazionale di Pneumatologia*, vols. I & II, ed. JOSE SARAIVA MARTINS (Vatican City: Libreria Editrice, 1983), especially JEAN-MARIE, R. TILLARD, “L’Esprit Saint dans la réflexion théologique contemporaine,” pp. 905-919. This collection is by-product of the International Theological Congress of Pneumatology held in Rome in 1982 on the occasion of the sixteenth centenary of the Council of Constantinople (381) and of the fifteenth hundred and fiftieth anniversary of the Council of Ephesus (431). A comprehensive recent trinitarian pneumatology is offered by Roman Catholic RALPH DEL COLLE, *Christ and the Spirit: Spirit-Christology in Trinitarian Perspective* (New York/Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1994). See also the whole issue of *The Ecumenical Review* 41:3, 1989.

According to many Orthodox theologians, priority is given to pneumatology in the East, and to christology in the West, although both profess the same trinitarian faith.<sup>16</sup> The Eastern tradition pays more attention to the Holy Spirit, both in the doctrine of salvation and in ecclesiology. Greek orthodox theologian and WCC-official Nikos A. Nissiotis<sup>17</sup>, following Vladimir Lossky<sup>18</sup>, has most dramatically articulated the charge of “Christomonism” against Western theology. According to him, Christianity in the West is seen as unilaterally referring to Christ, the Spirit being an addition to the church, to its ministries and sacraments. Although Nissiotis’ and Lossky’s critique is one-sided, and may be too harsh, there is no denying that a pneumatological deficiency has existed — and still does, in some quarters — in the Latin Church.<sup>19</sup>

Eastern pneumatologists have remarked that not even Vatican II with its many remarkable achievements, was “pneumatological enough.” *Lumen Gentium* was first written on christological foundations and pneumatological “tinsel” was added afterwards.<sup>20</sup> Catholic Walter Kasper, having listened to the critique of Eastern theologians, adds a keen criticism of Roman Catholic theology in this respect: “In modern theology one often gets the impression that pneumatology has become a function of ecclesiology; the Spirit has become the guarantor of the Church as an institution and pneumatology has become the ideological superstructure on top of ecclesiology.”<sup>21</sup>

<sup>16</sup> E.g., CONSTANTINE N. TSIRPANLIS, *Introduction to Eastern Patristic Thought and Christian Theology*. Theology and Life Series 30 (Collegeville, MN: The Liturgical Press, 1991), ch. 4; JOHN ZIZIOULAS, *Being as Communion. Studies in Personhood and the Church* (New York: St. Vladimir’s Seminary Press, 1985), ch. 3.

<sup>17</sup> NIKOS A. NISSIOTIS, “The Main Ecclesiological Problem of the Second Vatican Council and Position of the Non-Roman Churches Facing It,” *Journal of Ecumenical Studies* 6, 1965, pp. 31–62; *ibid.*, “La pneumatologie ecclesiologique au service de l’unité de l’Eglise,” *Istina* 12, 1967, 325ff. For the exposition of differences between Eastern and Western traditions on the Spirit, see e.g. YVES CONGAR, *I Believe in the Holy Spirit*, v. 3: *The River of Life Flows in the East and the West* (New York/London: Seabury/Chapman, 1983), pp. 211ff.

<sup>18</sup> E.g. VLADIMIR LOSSKY, *In the Image and Likeness of God*, ed. JOHN H. ERICKSON and THOMAS E. BIRD (New York: St. Vladimir’s Seminary Press, 1985), especially ch. 4 titled, “The Procession of the Holy Spirit in Orthodox Trinitarian Doctrine.”

<sup>19</sup> YVES CONGAR (*I Believe in the Holy Spirit*, v. 1: *The Experience of the Spirit* [New York/London: Seabury/Chapman, 1983], p. 152–266) chronicles in detail the ethos of “forgetfulness of the Spirit” in Catholic theology starting from Robert Bellarmine (1542–1621) until the Second Vatican Council (1962–1965). Lee, *Pneumatological Ecclesiology*, p. 195, names as the most obvious deficiencies of the West: (1) a weak regard for the epiclesis in the past, (2) the absence of a developed synodality, and (3) a certain clerical autonomy *vis-à-vis* the Christian community as a whole.

<sup>20</sup> E.g. ZIZIOULAS, *Being as Communion*, pp. 123ff.

<sup>21</sup> WALTER KASPER, *The God of Jesus Christ* (London: SCM Press, 1984), p. 138–139.

The Eastern critique of “Christomonism” in the West does not, of course, mean neglecting either Christ<sup>22</sup> or the Trinity<sup>23</sup> in Orthodox theologizing. On the contrary, a good case can be made for the claim that Eastern pneumatology is always anchored in Christology rather than operating as an independent theological *locus*.<sup>24</sup>

The ecclesiology of Eastern Orthodoxy, unlike most classical Western theologies, is permeated with pneumatology. Eastern theology never thinks of the Church apart from Christ and from the Holy Spirit.<sup>25</sup> Vladimir Lossky expresses this by speaking of the “two aspects of the Church”, the church as the body of Christ and fullness of the Spirit,<sup>26</sup> and John Zizioulas of the church as being “instituted” by Christ, and “constituted” by the Spirit.<sup>27</sup> The Spirit belongs to the *esse*, not just to the *bona esse* of the Church, since it lives in continual Pentecost:

But the Church is not only hierarchical, it is charismatic and Pentecostal. “Quench not the Spirit. Despise not prophesying” (1 Thessalonians 5, 19-20). The Holy Spirit is poured out upon all God’s people... In the Apostolic Church, besides the institutional ministry conferred by the laying on of hands, there were other *charismata* or gifts conferred directly by the Spirit: Paul mentions “gifts of healing,” the working of miracles, “speaking with tongues, and the like (I Corinthians 11, 28-30). In the Church of later days, these charismatic ministries have been less in evidence, but they have never been wholly extinguished.<sup>28</sup>

Besides ecclesiology, the doctrine of salvation in the Eastern Church is more pneumatologically oriented with its goal of *theosis* of

<sup>22</sup> See e.g. NIKOS A. NISSIOTIS, “Pneumatological Christology as a Presupposition of Ecclesiology,” in *Oecumenica: An Annual Symposium of Ecumenical Research* (Minneapolis: Augsburg, 1967), pp. 235-252.

<sup>23</sup> See e.g. VLADIMIR LOSSKY, *In the Image and Likeness of God*, ch. 4.

<sup>24</sup> See TSIRPANLIS, *Introduction to Eastern Patristic Thought*, pp. 83ff. He adds: “Those who speak of an Orthodox ‘Pneumatocentrism’ opposed to the so-called ‘Christocentrism’ of the Roman Church, may express their own personal theology, but they speak a language alien to the Fathers and to the saints of the Eastern Orthodox Church. The three Persons, in the Holy Trinity, share in the activity of each of them. The Father and the Son are included in every action of the Spirit.” (p. 85).

<sup>25</sup> VLADIMIR LOSSKY, *The Mystical Theology of the Eastern Church* (New York: St. Vladimir’s Seminary Press, 1957), p. 175; see also JOHN ZIZIOULAS, “Implications ecclésiologiques de deux types de pneumatologie,” in *Communio Sanctorum: Mélanges offerts à Jean-Jacques von Allmen* (Geneva: Labor et Fides, 1982), pp. 141-54.

<sup>26</sup> LOSSKY, *The Mystical Theology*, pp. 174ff.

<sup>27</sup> ZIZIOULAS, *Being as Communion*, p. 140; see also: *ibid*, “Die pneumatologische Dimension der Kirche,” *Internationale Katholische Zeitschrift “Communio”* 2, 1973, pp. 133-147.

<sup>28</sup> TIMOTHY WARE, *The Orthodox Church* (London: Penguin Books, 1993), pp. 249-50; see also pp. 240, 243.

men and women in the Spirit. It is interesting that along with resurgence of pneumatology there has also been a new ecumenical enthusiasm about the doctrine of deification even in Protestant circles.<sup>29</sup> This implies the potential of pneumatology for soteriology, too.

The entrance of the Eastern Orthodox Churches to the WCC has contributed to the strengthening and proliferation of pneumatological perspectives in WCC-theologies.<sup>30</sup> However, as some leading Eastern theologians have freely admitted, there is still need for further nuancing of Eastern pneumatology, especially in relation to ecclesiology and the Trinity.<sup>31</sup>

To the developments of pneumatology in WCC-theologies I turn next.

### *The Emergence of a Pneumatological Perspective in WCC-theologies*<sup>32</sup>

The Seventh General Assembly of the WCC in Canberra 1991 focused on the Holy Spirit. Rather than analyzing the outcomes of that particular meeting — the results of which are well documented and easily accessible<sup>33</sup> — I will trace briefly the development of a pneumatological perspective in the WCC culminating in Canberra.<sup>34</sup>

<sup>29</sup> The groundbreaking Lutheran study was written already in 1980 by Finnish Luther-expert TUOMO MANNERMAA, *In ipsa fide Christus adest. Luterilaisen and ortodoksisen kristinuskonkäsityksen leikkauspiste*. (In ipsa fide Christus adest. The Convergence of Lutheran and Orthodox view of Christianity). Schriften der Finnischen Gesellschaft für Missiologie und Ökumenik XXX. (Helsinki, 1980). Mannermaa's student Simo Peura has written a full scale study on the idea of *theosis* in Martin Luther. SIMO PEURA, *Mehr als ein Mensch? Die Vergöttlichung als Thema der Theologie Martin Luthers von 1513 bis 1519* (Mainz, 1994).

<sup>30</sup> So, e.g., Raiser, "The Holy Spirit," p. 375.

<sup>31</sup> ZIZIOULAS, *Being as Communion*, p. 126: "...Orthodox theology has no ready-made answers to offer to the problems at hand. It is often assumed that Orthodoxy can be helpful in the ecumenical discussions by contributing its Pneumatology to them. This may be true to some extent, especially if the Orthodox contribution is taken as a corrective to Western excesses in ecclesiology. But when it comes to the point of doing justice to the basic components of the Orthodox tradition itself or — and this is more important — to the point of facing our ecumenical problems with positive propositions, it becomes clear that Orthodox theology needs to work closely together with Western theology..."

<sup>32</sup> The reason I use the term *WCC-theologies* (in plural rather than in singular) reflects the conviction that there is no *definite* WCC-theology since that would be a contradiction in terms for a constituency that provides a forum for co-operation but not a defined communion.

<sup>33</sup> *Signs of the Spirit. Official Report. Seventh Assembly*, ed. MICHAEL KINNAMON (Geneva: WCC, 1991).

<sup>34</sup> In this section I am heavily indebted to RAISER, "The Holy Spirit," pp. 376ff. Useful information and insights can also be found in ALBERT C. OUTLER, "Pneumatology as an Ecumenical Frontier," *The Ecumenical Review* 41:3, 1989, 363-374.



Emergence of a pneumatological perspective among WCC-churches and elsewhere was partly prepared by the influential theologizing of Jürgen Moltmann of Tübingen, whose *The Church in the Power of the Spirit*<sup>35</sup> (1977) awakened expectations that were not disappointed by his magisterial *Spirit of Life*.<sup>36</sup> Certainly now the “forgetfulness” of the Spirit has given way to “a whole flood of writings about the Holy Spirit and its efficacies.”<sup>37</sup> His treatment has been labeled as a “systematic, theological elaboration of the World Council of Churches’ reflections on pneumatology,”<sup>38</sup> but Moltmann himself has not been willing to accept this honor.<sup>39</sup>

Another major pneumatology of this decade, *God the Spirit*<sup>40</sup> by another Tübingen systematician, Michael Welker, takes a much more reserved standpoint toward “natural pneumatologies” proposed by Moltmann and others. Welker’s work is permeated with explicit biblical argumentation. The appearance of these two pneumatologies reflects the polarity in theologizing about the Spirit, especially in Protestant ecumenical circles.

In the reports of the major ecumenical conferences prior to the formation of the WCC, reference to the Holy Spirit remains fairly traditional, following the lines of average Protestant thinking. The Trinitarian confession of faith is acknowledged formally, but the affirmation of the Spirit as person in communion with the Father and the Son remains largely undeveloped. According to Raiser, this relative subordination of the Holy Spirit to the person of Jesus was fairly representative of the general setting of Protestant theology and evangelical piety of those years.<sup>41</sup> The Faith and Order conferences at Lausanne (1927) and Edinburgh (1937) refer to the Holy Spirit mainly in relation to the church, as the one who gives life to the church. The Spirit sanctifies and renews the church through word and sacrament and draws it into unity.<sup>42</sup>

<sup>35</sup> JÜRGEN MOLTSMANN, *The Church in the Power of the Spirit: A Contribution to Messianic Ecclesiology* (New York: Harper & Row, 1977).

<sup>36</sup> MOLTSMANN, *The Spirit of Life*. The subtitle in the German original, *Eine ganzheitliche Pneumatologie* (Engl. subtitle, *A Universal Affirmation*), stresses the basic intention of the author of writing a “holistic pneumatology”.

<sup>37</sup> MOLTSMANN, *The Spirit of Life*, p. 1.

<sup>38</sup> M. STIBBE, “A British Appraisal (Dialogue with J. Moltmann’s *Spirit of Life*),” *Journal of Pentecostal Theology* 4, 1994, p. 6.

<sup>39</sup> JÜRGEN MOLTSMANN, “A Response to my Pentecostal Dialogue Partners,” *Journal of Pentecostal Theology* 4, 1994, p. 61.

<sup>40</sup> MICHAEL WELKER, *God the Spirit* (Minneapolis: Fortress Press, 1994).

<sup>41</sup> RAISER, “The Holy Spirit,” p. 376.

<sup>42</sup> Edinburgh, section III, in *A Documentary History of the Faith and Order Movement 1927-1963*, ed. L. VISCHER (St Louis: Bethany, 1963), 45, #29.



The reports of the First Assembly of the WCC at Amsterdam (1948) concentrated on Christ who brings forth the church. It is affirmed that the Church persists in continuity throughout history through the presence and power of the Holy Spirit.<sup>43</sup> Interestingly enough, the expression “re-cover[ing] the spirit of prophecy to discern the signs of the times”, which became one of the catch-words of Vatican II, was employed here.<sup>44</sup>

The International Missionary Conference at Willingen, and the Faith and Order Conference at Lund, both in 1952, reached a new understanding of the missionary task as participation in the *missio Dei*. Through the Spirit, the church can proclaim God’s saving work in Christ and wait for his final victory. The Lund conference affirmed many earlier pronouncements on the Spirit. The continuity of the church in history is assured “by the constant action of the risen Lord through the Holy Spirit”, and it is through the “unifying power of His indwelling Spirit” that the organic unity of the body of Christ is sustained.<sup>45</sup>

It is at the Third Assembly of the WCC at New Delhi (1961) that the new orientation becomes clearly visible. The basis of the WCC was enlarged to envision an explicitly Trinitarian, doxological formulation: “to the glory of the one God, Father, Son and Holy Spirit.”<sup>46</sup> The preamble to the statement places the understanding of unity in a Trinitarian, pneumatological setting:

The love of the Father and the Son in the unity of the Holy Spirit is the source and goal of the unity which the triune God wills for all men and creation. We believe that we share in this unity in the Church of Jesus Christ... The reality of this unity was made manifest at Pentecost in the gift of the Holy Spirit, through whom we know in this present age the first fruits of that perfect union of the Son with his Father, which will be known in its fullness only when all things are consummated by Christ in his glory.<sup>47</sup>

<sup>43</sup> Amsterdam, section I, in *ibid.*, 78, #11.

<sup>44</sup> Amsterdam, section II, in *The Church’s Witness to God’s Design* (New York: Harper & Brothers, 1948), p. 222.

<sup>45</sup> Lund, section I, in *A Documentary History*, 90, #19.

<sup>46</sup> W.A. VISSER ‘T HOOFT, “The Basis: its History and Significance,” *The Ecumenical Review* 2, 1985, 170ff.

<sup>47</sup> New Delhi section on unity, in *A Documentary History*, 144, #1. RAISER (p. 378) pays special attention to the Orthodox contribution to this unity formula and refers to the important article by NIKOS NISSIOTIS, “The Witness and the Service of Eastern Orthodoxy to the One Undivided Church,” in *The Orthodox Church in the Ecumenical Movement*, ed. C. Patelos (Geneva: WCC, 1978), pp. 231ff.

The Montreal Faith and Order Conference (1963) built on New Delhi and developed the pneumatological perspective, especially in relation to Scripture and Tradition as well as to the delicate issue of ministry. The statement on ministry already anticipated the rise of Charismatic Movements and the renaissance of *charismata* in the church: "The Holy Spirit dwells in the Church... He also bestows differing gifts (*charismata*) on groups and individuals... All members of the Church are thus gifted for the common good."<sup>48</sup> After the Montreal meeting there came new studies on pneumatology, especially to study the pneumatological understanding between East and West, based on patristic studies, as well as further study on "Christ, the Holy Spirit, and the Ministry." Another influential study was on the relation of sacraments and the Spirit (Bristol, 1967). But it was not until the Uppsala Assembly (1968) that the first explicit address to the Holy Spirit was issued. Paragraph 8 of section I "proves the fullest summary of ecumenical thinking on the Holy Spirit up to that moment."<sup>49</sup>

Faith and Order at Louvain (1971) gathered together studies initiated at Montreal, and was paving way for the most important document of Faith and Order, *Baptism, Eucharist and Ministry*, issued about ten years later.<sup>50</sup> Raiser synthesizes the development of pneumatological perspective after Louvain in four statements.

— First, there is the role of the Holy Spirit in the confession of the faith. The influential study on *filioque* suggested that there needs to be "a new sensitivity to the person and work of the Holy Spirit as the one who in his fullness both rests upon Jesus Christ and is the gift of Christ to the Church, the Lord and Giver of life to humankind and all creation."<sup>51</sup> The project *Confessing One Faith* has been far-reaching in the study of the Spirit in confessions.<sup>52</sup> It explicates the classical affirmation about the Holy Spirit in the Nicene-Constantinopolitan Creed.

— Second is the relation of the Spirit and church. Here, of course, *Baptism, Eucharist and Ministry* stands in the forefront. The pneumato-

<sup>48</sup> Montreal, section III, in *The Fourth World Conference on Faith and Order. The Report from Montreal 1963*, eds. P.C. RODGER and L. VISCHER (New York: Association Press, 1964), p. 65, #92.

<sup>49</sup> RAISER, "The Holy Spirit," p. 380; see *The Uppsala 68 Report*, ed. N. GOODALL (Geneva: WCC, 1968).

<sup>50</sup> Faith and Order Paper 111 (Geneva: WCC, 1982).

<sup>51</sup> *Spirit of God, Spirit of Christ. Ecumenical Reflections on the Filioque Controversy*, ed. L. VISCHER (London: SPCK/Geneva: WCC, 1981), p. 18.

<sup>52</sup> *Confessing One Faith. Towards an Ecumenical Explication of the Apostolic Faith*. Faith and Order Paper 140 (Geneva, 1987).

logical perspective, though, not the focus of the study, is present in relation to sacraments and ministry, based on the pneumatological understanding of the church.

— The more churches from the Third World have joined the WCC, the more the issues of the Spirit and religious pluralism, the third topic in Raiser's summary, have come to focus.<sup>53</sup> Moltmann's and others' recent works have nuanced theologically the developments which have come out of the theology of religions and the role of the Spirit in all of it.

— The fourth aspect of development is the emergence of charismatic renewal among WCC-churches as well as in the Roman Catholic church. Beginning in the 1960s many member churches have experienced manifestations of a charismatic renewal focusing on the baptism of the Holy Spirit, charismatic ministry, and various *charismata*. I will briefly look at the contribution of Pentecostal and Charismatic theologies after I have first surveyed pneumatological perspectives in recent Catholic theologies.

The most recent development in the WCC, to bear on the pneumatological perspective is the influence of the Faith and Order Conference at Santiago de Compostela (1993).<sup>54</sup> Its emphasis on *koinonia*-theology carries potential for pneumatological developments, since there is a growing consensus on the church as "communion in the Spirit".<sup>55</sup>

### *The Potential of Catholic Pneumatology after Vatican II*

The year 1998 in the Roman Catholic Church worldwide, in preparation for crossing into the third millennium, has been assigned, under the enthusiastic leadership of Pope John Paul II,<sup>56</sup> to special devotion to the

<sup>53</sup> See STANLEY J. SAMARTHA, "The Holy Spirit and Peoples of Various Faiths," in *Courage for Dialogue* (Geneva: WCC, 1981).

<sup>54</sup> For conference proceedings, see "On the Way to Fuller Koinonia". Messages to the Churches. WCC, Fifth Conference on Faith and Order, Santiago de Compostela, Spain 3-14 August 1993.

<sup>55</sup> The space here does not, of course, allow us to go into a more detailed discussion of this perspective. For some initial considerations of the idea of "church as *koinonia* in the Spirit", see VELI-MATTI KÄRKKÄINEN, *Spiritus ubi vult spirat. Pneumatology in Roman Catholic-Pentecostal Dialogue 1972-1989. Schriften der Luther-Agricola-Gesellschaft* (Helsinki: Luther-Agricola-Society, 1998), chs. 5 and 6.

<sup>56</sup> Pope JOHN PAUL II, *Celebrate 2000! Reflections on the Holy Spirit*. Weekly Readings for 1998, sel. and arr. Paul Thigpar (Ann Arbor, Michigan: Servant Publisher, 1997). In a recent visit to Latin America, Pope John Paul II issued an exhortation: "Be open to Christ, welcome the Spirit, so that a new Pentecost may take place in every community!". Ibid, "Challenges Facing the Latin American Church," *The Pope Speaks* 38:2, p. 101.

Holy Spirit, as the previous year was to the Son and the following to the Father. Issuing of publications, celebration of special services, and organizing lectures and research programs took place as the largest church of Christendom desire to deepen her understanding of pneumatology and cultivate the cult of the Spirit. The 1996 Catholic Theological Society of America meeting was devoted to the pneumatology: "Toward a Spirited Theology: Challenges of the Holy Spirit to Theological Disciplines."<sup>57</sup>

Vatican II, of course, was instrumental in the new Catholic pneumatological renaissance. Pope John XXIII, when formally announcing the Council, wrote: "This getting together of all the bishops of the Church should be like a new Pentecost".<sup>58</sup> This council could be called the "Council of the Holy Spirit", for as Pope Paul VI pointed out there are two hundred and fifty-eight references to the Holy Spirit in the pages of the Council documents.<sup>59</sup> And since the Council the popes have urged theologians and lay people alike to revive their interest on the Spirit.<sup>60</sup>

In terms of ecclesiology, the most important development of Vatican II was the replacement of the old "*societas perfecta*"<sup>61</sup>, institutional-hierarchical ecclesiology, by a dynamic "People of God"-notion, where the church is first of all seen as a pilgrimage people on the way to the Heavenly City.<sup>62</sup> This understanding was very much prepared by the highly influential theological work of Yves Congar, who also had distinguished himself as a pneumatologist. Very soon, the theology of *koinonia* was adopted by several leading Catholic ecclesiologists, although there are

<sup>57</sup> *Proceedings of the Fifty-first Annual Convention, San Diego June 6-9, 1996*, vol. 51, ed. JUDITH A. DWYER (Catholic Theological Society of America, 1996).

<sup>58</sup> GERMAIN, MARC'HADOUR, "The Holy Spirit over the New World: II," *The Clergy Review* 59:4, 1974, p. 247.

<sup>59</sup> MARC'HADOUR, "The Holy Spirit," p. 248. See also: E. E. O'CONNOR, *The Pentecostal Movement in the Catholic Church* (Notre Dame: Ave Maria, 1971), p. 184. For a moving account of the experience of the Council, see OUTLER, "Pneumatology," p. 363.

<sup>60</sup> For papal documents and evaluations of their significance, see KILIAN McDONNELL, *Open the Windows. The Popes and Charismatic Renewal* (South Bend, Indiana: Greenlawn Press, 1989).

<sup>61</sup> The view of the church as a perfect society enjoyed widespread support from the time of the Counter Reformation to the first half of the twentieth century. "That model was weak since it neglected the role of the Holy Spirit, the pneumatological dimension", states Catholic theologian MICHAEL A. FAHEY, "Church," in *Systematic Theology: Roman Catholic Perspectives*, vol. 2, ed. FRANCIS SCHUSSLER FIORENZA and JOHN P. GALVIN (Minneapolis: Fortress Press, 1991), p. 32.

<sup>62</sup> Instead of beginning with a description of the church as perfect society, the first chapter of *Lumen Gentium* [hereafter *LG*] notes the reflection of the inner life of the triune God in the church itself. Borrowing a phrase from Saint Cyprian of Carthage (d. 258), the council states: "Hence the universal church is seen to be a 'people brought into unity from the unity of the Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit'" (*LG* 4).

still some major divergencies between them and the curia about what it means in the Catholic context. Both of these ecclesiological breakthroughs are pneumatologically pregnant.<sup>63</sup> Along with ecclesiological re-thinking, reassessment of sacramental theology has taken a pneumatological course, as in Protestant theologies, too, with the idea about the church as the sacrament of the Spirit, and sacraments consequently integrated with *epiklesis*.<sup>64</sup>

The explicit emphasis upon the pneumatic nature of the Church, including the gifts and graces of the Holy Spirit, was secured in the Council by Leon Joseph Cardinal Suenens, who played such a critical role in assuring the college of bishops of the importance of the Holy Spirit and of spiritual gifts to the future of the Roman church.<sup>65</sup> Catholic systematician Michael A. Fahey, states that “another way that the church is described in the perspective of the Second Vatican Council is as a community of charisms.”<sup>66</sup> In this understanding the church is seen as the Body of Christ “created, ordered, and sustained by the charismatic inspirations of the Breath of the risen Jesus”.<sup>67</sup> Paderborn’s systematician Heribert Mühlen has developed some of the key ideas of *Lumen Gentium* by arguing that the church is seen “as the continuation of the Anointing with the Spirit of Jesus at his baptism.”<sup>68</sup>

<sup>63</sup> For a good overview of the most recent developments in ecclesiology (especially *koinonia-theology*) and pneumatology, see the seminal study by MICHAEL G. LAWLER and THOMAS, J. SHANAHAN, *Church: A Spirited Communion* (Collegeville, MN: The Liturgical Press, 1995); MIGUEL M. GARIJO-GUEMBE, *Communion of the Saints. Foundation, Nature, and Structure of the Church*, tr. Patrick Madigan (Collegeville, MN: The Liturgical Press, 1994).

<sup>64</sup> See e.g. W. KASPER and G. SAUTER, *Kirche - Ort des Geistes* (Freiburg: Herder, 1976).

<sup>65</sup> JERRY L. SANDIDGE, *Roman Catholic-Pentecostal Dialogue (1977-1982): A Study in Developing Ecumenism*, vol. 1. Studien zur interkulturellen Geschichte des Christentums 44 (Frankfurt: Peter Lang), p. 25.

<sup>66</sup> FAHEY, “Church,” p. 39. He goes on to say: “In the Catholic community, as in the Christian community in general except possibly for Pentecostal Christians, there had been a general neglect of the term *charism*. It was almost as though charisms were important in the early church, the age of charism was dead.” He defines the charism like this: “A gift of ability conveyed to an individual within the Christian community enabling the person to fulfill a specific service, either over a long period of time or in a relatively short period of time.”

<sup>67</sup> GELPI, “The Theological Challenge,” p. 187. He refers to the following Vatican II documents: LG 6, 32, 48, 50; *Unitatis Redintegratio* [hereafter UR] 3; *Apostolicam Actuositatem* [hereafter AA] 3.

<sup>68</sup> HERIBERT MÜHLEN, “Charismatic and Sacramental Understanding of the Church: Dogmatic Aspects of Charismatic Renewal,” *One in Christ* 12, 1976, pp. 333ff.; see also his *Una Mystica Persona. Die Kirche als das Mysterium der Identität des Heiligen Geistes in Christus und den Christen: eine Person in vielen Personen* (Paderborn: Ferdinand Schöning, 1967). This is, of course, totally different from what the earlier textbooks said about the church as the continuation of Christ’s incarnation.

Both *Lumen Gentium*<sup>69</sup> and *Apostolicam Actuositatem*<sup>70</sup> as well as *Presbyterorum Ordinis*<sup>71</sup> establish the existence and contribution of charisms under the supervision of shepherds of the church. Vatican II emphasized repeatedly the Spirit's sovereign freedom in dispensing the charisms.<sup>72</sup> The council insisted on the universal availability of the charisms: the Spirit calls all Christians, ordained and lay alike, to some form of charismatic ministry.<sup>73</sup>

Jesuit theologian Donald Gelpi, though, criticizes his own church for not taking seriously the charismatic and pneumatological teaching of the Second Vatican Council. He thinks it is not the so called "Catholic Charismatic Movement" that has responsibility to renew the church, but it is precisely the burden of the whole church with her theologians and teachers to implement what was rediscovered in the Council.<sup>74</sup> He argues that the charisms play an indispensable role in the life of the Church and they therefore cannot be confined to the first generation of Christians, as most Catholics before Vatican II were taught to believe.<sup>75</sup> Kilian McDonnell, OSB, said that "the charisms of the Spirit play an indispensable role in the life of the Church because they create the shared faith consciousness of the Christian community".<sup>76</sup>

McDonnell, in the course of his extensive writings during the last two decades on various aspects of pneumatology and ecclesiology, has tirelessly appealed for a truly pneumatological ecclesiology.<sup>77</sup> Now it has

<sup>69</sup> LG 12

<sup>70</sup> AA 3.

<sup>71</sup> *Presbyterorum Ordinis* 9; LG 30.

<sup>72</sup> AA 3; AG 23; LG 7.

<sup>73</sup> AA 3, 28, 30; LG 4.

<sup>74</sup> GELPI, "The Theological Challenge," p. 188-189. When evaluating the role of the Catholic Charismatic Movement after 25 years of existence in 1982, Gelpi is not happy with the way the church theologians responded to it and to the pneumatic-charismatic teaching of Vatican II: "Theologians, however, tended at first to look somewhat aghast upon this rag-tag collection of enthusiastic, Catholic tongue-speakers. With time, of course, the theological community did come to take the renewal more seriously; but their failure to respond with clarity to the challenge this movement posed to the Church as a whole created a doctrinal vacuum into which others rushed, many of them spokespersons for the Classical Pentecostal tradition." (p. 188).

<sup>75</sup> See DONALD J. GELPI, *Charism and Sacrament* (New York/London: Paulist Press/SPCK, 1976), pp. 97-110 especially; *Ibid*, *The Divine Mother: A Trinitarian Theology of the Holy Spirit* (Lanham, MD: University Press of America, 1984), pp. 103ff.

<sup>76</sup> KILIAN McDONNELL, "Communion Ecclesiology and Baptism in the Spirit: Tertulian and the Early Church," *Theological Studies* 49, 1988, 671ff.

<sup>77</sup> KILIAN McDONNELL ("The Determinative Doctrine of the Holy Spirit," *Theology Today* 39, 1982, pp. 142-161) points out the narrow approaches to pneumatology in the past, which lack the ecclesiological, public dimension: "In both Protestantism and



become more and more obvious to the emerging ecumenical ecclesiology that as the Spirit is constitutive of the identity of Israel as God's people<sup>78</sup>, so does the Spirit belong to the constitutive moment of the existence of the church. It is not enough to add the Spirit later, after the Church has been instituted, as a sort of 'decorative tinsel', as it was still with the pneumatology of *Lumen Gentium*, with all its otherwise positive contributions.<sup>79</sup> It builds up the Church in christological terms, and then when the christological moment is all over, the Spirit is added in a second moment, McDonnell laments. This approach he names "consequent pneumatology".<sup>80</sup> "This is too late. The Spirit belongs to the first constitutive moment. This has profound implications for the life of the Church, evangelization, preaching, liturgy<sup>81</sup>, the Christian life."<sup>82</sup> This has also been the focus of persistent Greek Orthodox critique of the ecclesiology of Vatican II, as we saw above.

Catholicism, the doctrine of the Holy Spirit, or pneumatology, has to do mostly with private, not public experience. In Protestantism, the interest in pneumatology has been largely in pietism where it is a function of interiority and inwardness. In Roman Catholicism, its dominant expression has been in books on spirituality or on the charismatic renewal, or when speaking of the structural elements of the church. In the West, we think essentially in Christological categories, with the Holy Spirit as an extra, an addendum, a "false" window to give symmetry and balance to theological design. We build up our large theological constructs in constitutive Christological categories, and then, in a second, non-constitutive moment, we decorate the already constructed system with pneumatological baubles, a little Spirit tinsel." (p. 142). McDonnell notes that Paul Tillich (*Systematic Theology*, three vols. in one [Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 1967]) is one of the rare theologians who did develop a pneumatology in relation to ecclesiology and *vice versa* (p. 155).

<sup>78</sup> KILIAN McDONNELL, "Pneumatology Overview: Trinitarian Guidelines for Speaking About the Holy Spirit, in *Proceedings*, p. 188.

<sup>79</sup> McDONNELL, "Pneumatology Overview," pp. 188-189.

<sup>80</sup> KILIAN McDONNELL, "Vatican II (1962-1965), Puebla (1979), Synod (1985): *Koinonia/Communio* as an Integrating Ecclesiology," *Journal of Ecumenical Studies* 25, 1988, p. 402. He notes that in *Ad Gentes*, a document written after *Lumen Gentium*, some of the criticism of the lack of pneumatology was corrected: "There is still a kind of 'second pneumatological moment' in the ecclesiology, that is, the church is constructed in christological categories, and then the Spirit is 'added'. However, now there is recognition that the Holy Spirit was at work in the world before Christ was glorified. (*Ad Gentes* 4)."

<sup>81</sup> McDonnell finds fault, too, with *Sacrosanctum Concilium* for its lack of developed pneumatology undergirding the teaching on liturgy. "Here the Holy Spirit did not even attain the level of an ornament." McDONNELL, "The Determinative Doctrine," p. 159; *ibid.*, "A Trinitarian Theology," p. 192.

<sup>82</sup> "When the work which the Father had given the Son to do on earth (cf. Jn 17:4) was accomplished, the Holy Spirit was sent on the day of Pentecost in order that He might forever sanctify the church..." *LG*, 4. See also McDONNELL, "Pneumatology Overview," p. 189; *ibid.*, "Vatican II," p. 402-404. Orthodox BORIS BOBRINSKOY ("Holy Spirit," in *Dictionary of the Ecumenical Movement*, p. 470) agrees with McDonnell: "The theology of the Holy Spirit, or, pneumatology, is not so much one specific chapter of Christian theology as an essential dimension of every theological view of the church and of its spirituality and liturgical and sacramental life." See also YVES CONGAR, "Pneumatologie ou 'Chris-



Several Catholic theologians have remarked recently that the pneumatological aspect must be seen together with the fact that the Church, in its confession of faith, is said to be connected with the Holy Spirit. The Church is named in the creeds<sup>83</sup> in the clause after the Holy Spirit.<sup>84</sup> According to the *Traditio apostolica* of Hippolytus, the third baptismal question runs: "Do you believe in the Holy Spirit in the Church?"<sup>85</sup>

Miguel M. Garijo-Guembe of Spain notes that as the apostles were baptized in the Holy Spirit at Pentecost, in the same way the communion of the faithful is made fruitful today through the gifts of the Spirit.<sup>86</sup> The close connection between Holy Spirit and Church in the early centuries reveals the three basic convictions which are normative for us, too: (1) It was the Spirit who was active in ancient prophets and who had prophesied the coming and experiences of the Savior. (2) The Spirit enlightens the Church and leads her into the truth; it fills her with its charisms, and is effective in sacraments (cf. *epiclesis*). (3) The Spirit guarantees the faithful a share in eternal life, that is, victory over death.<sup>87</sup> This ecclesial conviction about the integral relationship between the Spirit and the Church was expressed so clearly by Irenaeus: "For where the Church is, there is also the Spirit of God. And where the Spirit of God is, there is also the Church and all grace; for the Spirit is the Truth."<sup>88</sup>

The resurgence of pneumatology and pneumatological ecclesiology and sacramentology has opened up new prospects in the search for Christian unity, too, in Catholic theologies.

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tomonisme' dans la tradition latine," *Ecclesia a Spiritu Sancto edocta*. Festschrift for Gérard Philips (Louvain: Duculot, 1970), pp. 41-63.

<sup>83</sup> E.g., the Creed of Constantinople and the (Western) Apostles' Creed.

<sup>84</sup> GARIJO-GUEMBE, *Communion of Saints*, p. 2: "From the Creed itself it should be clear that ecclesiology can only be understood in connection with and as a consequence of pneumatology. The Church cannot be grasped apart from the Holy Spirit, and can only be grasped as the work of the Holy Spirit. Only after Pentecost, that is, after the sending of the Spirit through the Risen One ...". Thomas Aquinas articulates the medieval tradition: "The phrase 'the holy catholic church' is to be understood to mean that our faith is in the Holy Spirit who sanctifies the church. The meaning is, therefore, I believe in the Holy Spirit sanctifying the church." *ST* 2-2.1.9. ad 5.

<sup>85</sup> Cited in GARIJO-GUEMBE, *Communion of Saints*, p. 1. Patristic author Faustus of Riez (d. before 500) concluded that the last clauses in the Creed were connected with the Holy Spirit: "Whatever in the Creed follows the words 'the Holy Ghost' should be understood without reference to the preposition 'in,' so that our belief about the Holy Church, the communion of saints, etc., is said as part of our appeal to God. This means we believe that these things have been ordered by God and derive their existence from him." *De Spiritu Sancto* 1.2.; *CSEL* 21:103f.

<sup>86</sup> GARIJO-GUEMBE, *Communion of Saints*, p.xi.

<sup>87</sup> GARIJO-GUEMBE, *Communion of Saints*, p. 1.

<sup>88</sup> *Adv. Haer.* 3.24.1.; *PG* 7:966.

Several Catholic ecumenists have recently pointed to the indispensable role of pneumatology in ecumenical theology. Avery Dulles, noted for his “models”, thinks that the rules of ecumenical theology must be “biblically rooted, ecclesially responsible, open to criticism, and sensitive to the present leading of the Holy Spirit.”<sup>89</sup> Philip Rosato declares confidently that pneumatology offers the divided Christian communities a new meeting place for dialogue.<sup>90</sup> Dietrich Ritschl has elaborated a “therapeutic task of theology”, where the plurality and diversity promoted by the Holy Spirit is acknowledged as a condition for unity.<sup>91</sup> Paul D. Lee, taking up the Johannine image of the Spirit as the *paraclete*, speaks about a true ecumenical theology as a healer, a consoler, an advocate.<sup>92</sup> Here the role of the Spirit is seen as “the go-between God”, the bond of love, uniting men and women to God and to each other.<sup>93</sup>

It is noteworthy that the Roman Catholic Church has been the first and, until 1996 when the International Dialogue between the World Alliance of Reformed Churches and World Pentecostal Churches was initiated, the only church to begin official dialogues with Pentecostals and Charismatics. Catholic ecumenist Paul D. Lee, who has recently written his doctoral dissertation on some aspects of this dialogue, has argued that the dialogue has helped Catholic theologians to “test” a truly pneumatological approach to Christian unity.

This science [i.e. pneumatology] provides a fresh ecumenical meeting-ground, especially as regards a theologically more agreeable understanding of the Church. The Spirit continuously brings to the Church hope, vigor, and new insights. Today’s renewed interest in pneumatology among Christians has positive implications for a more comprehensive and theocentric ecclesiology. A growing convergence in the theology of the Holy Spirit promises new breakthroughs, for instance, in the traditional ecclesiological tensions between “the charismatic” and the “institutional,” be-

<sup>89</sup> AVERY DULLES, “Method in Ecumenical Theology,” *The Craft of Theology: From Symbol to System*, ed. AVERY DULLES (New York: Crossroad, 1992), p. 195. In this sense we could criticize the model of ecumenical theology posed by Hans Küng, because of its total lack of pneumatological reference as is clearly seen in his definition of ecumenism in Hans Küng, *Theology for the Third Millennium: An Ecumenical View* (New York: Doubleday, 1988), pp. 169, 206.

<sup>90</sup> PHILIP ROSATO, “Called by God, in the Holy Spirit: Pneumatological Insights into Ecumenism,” *The Ecumenical Review* 30, 1978, 110-126.

<sup>91</sup> D. RITSCHL, “The Search for Implicit Axioms behind Doctrinal Texts,” *GREGORIANUM* 74:2, 1993, p. 219.

<sup>92</sup> LEE, *Pneumatological Ecclesiology*, pp. 33-34.

<sup>93</sup> J.V. TAYLOR, *The Go-Between God: The Holy Spirit and Christian Mission* (London, 1972), p. 43-44.

tween the laity and the clergy, between the historical and the eschatological, and between understandings of the Church as “an event” and as “an organization”.<sup>94</sup>

Pneumatology offers “an eschatological hope to be experienced and realized now”, “a new meeting place for dialogue” in the midst of divided Christendom, Lee further contends.<sup>95</sup> It brings with it new hope and new challenges for ecumenical work.<sup>96</sup>

### *The Contribution of Pentecostalism and Charismatic Movements*

Two major shapers of Christian *oikumene* after the Reformation/Counter Reformation have been the emergence of ecumenical consciousness — both in terms of the formation of WCC and opening up of the Catholic Church to ecumenism as a result of Vatican II — and the birth of the Pentecostal<sup>97</sup>, and later Charismatic<sup>98</sup>, movements.

The dramatic spread of the Pentecostal movement throughout the world has made other Christians wake up to its significance. From humble beginnings at the Azusa Street revival in Los Angeles, California, at the beginning of this century, it has become the largest single category in Protestantism, the “third force”<sup>99</sup> in Christianity, outstripping the traditional groups that date back to the Reformation such as the Lutheran, Reformed, and Anglican communions.<sup>100</sup> The Pentecostal movement is the

<sup>94</sup> LEE, *Pneumatological Ecclesiology*, p. 2.

<sup>95</sup> LEE, *Pneumatological Ecclesiology*, p. 277.

<sup>96</sup> Lee, *Pneumatological Ecclesiology*, p. 287.

<sup>97</sup> The best guide to the origins, theology and spirituality of world-wide Pentecostalism is *Dictionary of Pentecostal and Charismatic Movements*, ed. STANLEY M. BURGESS and GARY B. MCGEE (Grand Rapids, MI: Zondervan, 1988). The classic introduction to the topic is offered by the most noted observer of the Pentecostal phenomenon, WALTER J. HOLLENWEGER, *The Pentecostals* (Peabody, MA: Hendrickson, 1972). Fortunately enough, we have now a massive sequel to this: *ibid*, *Pentecostalism. Origins and Developments Worldwide* (Peabody, MA: Hendrickson, 1997), which will become the definitive guide to the subject for years to come. All of these sources give ample bibliographical guidance for an interested reader.

<sup>98</sup> The *Dictionary* mentioned in the previous note is the best guide to the study of Charismatic Movements too. The article by the Catholic observer Peter D. Hocken (“Charismatic Movement,” pp. 130-160) is an especially helpful introduction. Basic bibliographical references may be found there.

<sup>99</sup> A phrase coined by H.P. VAN DUSEN, “The Third Force in Christendom,” *Life* 44, June 1958, p. 13.

<sup>100</sup> HENRY I. LEDERLE, *Treasures Old and New. Interpretations of “Spirit-Baptism” in the Charismatic Renewal Movement* (Peabody, MA: Hendrickson, 1988), p. 15. A Pentecostal missiologist, L. GRANT MCCLUNG, Jr., referring to the most recent calculations of the renowned Anglican-Baptist statistician, D. B. Barrett writes: “David Barrett’s descrip-

most rapidly growing missionary movement in the world and in the history of Christendom. "A growth of from zero to 400 million in ninety years is unprecedented in the whole of church history."<sup>101</sup> There are specialists who expect that in the next century it will overshadow the Catholic Church numerically.<sup>102</sup>

Such a dramatic growth has brought new questions to theology, and the existence of Pentecostal-Charismatic Christianity cannot any more be overlooked, certainly not in ecumenical theology, although — especially in Europe — ecumenical theologizing still goes on like nothing had happened to the tapestry of the Christian Church.

The author of *The Secular City* in the 1960s, Harvard theologian Harvey Cox, has, in the 1990s, awakened mainline theologians to stop pretending that the world's largest growing segment is of no interest.<sup>103</sup> "The rise of the charismatic movement within virtually every mainstream church has ensured that the Holy Spirit figures prominently on the theological agenda. A new experience of reality and power of the Spirit has had a major impact upon the theological discussion of the per-

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tion of the Pentecostal/Charismatic tradition, now numbering more than 400 million and growing by 19 million a year and 54,000 a day, is that it comes in an 'amazing variety' of 38 major categories, 11,000 Pentecostal denominations and 3,000 independent Charismatic denominations spread across 8,000 ethnolinguistic cultures and 7,000 languages. A cross section of worldwide Pentecostalism reveals a composite international Pentecostal/Charismatic who is more urban than rural, more female than male, more Third World (66 %) than Western world, more impoverished (87%) than affluent, more family-oriented than individualistic, and, on the average younger than eighteen." L. GRANT MCCLUNG, "Pentecostal/Charismatic Perspectives on a Missiology for the Twenty-First Century," *PNEUMA: The Journal of the Society for Pentecostal Studies* 16:1, 1994, p. 12. For other statistical details, see also: DAVID BARRETT, "Signs, Wonders, and Statistics in the World of Today," in *Pentecost, Mission and Ecumenism. Essays on Intercultural Theology: Festschrift in Honor of Professor Walter J. Hollenweger*, ed. JAN A.B. JONGENEEL (Frankfurt am Main/Berlin/New York/Wien: Lang, 1992), pp. 189-196.

<sup>101</sup> WALTER J. HOLLENWEGER, "From Azusa Street to Toronto Phenomenon: Historical Roots of the Pentecostal Movement," *Concilium* 3, p. 3.

<sup>102</sup> HOLLENWEGER, "From Azusa Street," p. 3. If, currently, Roman Catholics are the largest Christian group, then classical Pentecostals are now the second largest, and gaining fast. In the 1980s the Pentecostals (193 million) exceeded the Orthodox Christians (179 million). Catholics now number about 950.000.000. As of 1990 Roman Catholics constitute 58% of all affiliated Christian church members, while Pentecostals make up 21%. "They are multiplying geometrically", observers Kilian McDonnell, the Roman Catholic specialist on Pentecostalism and Charismatic Christianity. KILIAN McDONNELL, "Improbable Conversations: The International Classical Pentecostal/Roman Catholic Dialogue," *PNEUMA: The Journal of the Society for Pentecostal Studies* 17:2, 1995, p. 165.

<sup>103</sup> HARVEY COX, *Fire From Heaven: The Rise of Pentecostal Spirituality and the Reshaping of Religion in the Twenty-First Century* (Massachusetts: Addison-Wesley Publishing Company, 1995). See also *ibid*, "Why God Didn't Die: A Religious Renaissance Flourishing Around the World - Pentecostal Christians Leading the Way," *Nieman Reports* (The Nieman Foundation at Harvard University) 47.2., Summer 1993, 6-8, 47-49.

son and work of the Holy Spirit," remarks Anglican Alistair McGrath.<sup>104</sup> Many others have made similar remarks.<sup>105</sup>

To be sure, Pentecostalism has not developed much theology, being a lay-led charismatic renewal of spirituality.<sup>106</sup> Its mode of doing theology has been oral/experiential rather than the discursive/analytic way familiar to the Western academy.<sup>107</sup> It reflects the way theology is mainly done in Third World cultures where testimonies, songs, visions, dreams are preferred over lectures, studies and analytical discussions. "The salient characteristic of Pentecostalism is its belief in the present-day manifestation of spiritual gifts, such as miraculous healing, prophecy and, most distinctively, glossolalia. Pentecostals affirm that these spiritual gifts (charismata) are granted by the Holy Spirit and are normative in contemporary church life and ministry."<sup>108</sup> Many observers of the movement hold that this challenge, in spirituality and enthusiasm — in the "revalorization of the Charismata"<sup>109</sup> — rather than in theological analysis, entails the most important contribution of Pentecostalism and later Charismatic Movements.<sup>110</sup> Pentecostalism has also (re)introduced a dynamic, enthusiastic type of spirituality to the modern church. The focus of Pentecostal spirituality is experiencing God mystically as supernatural. The category of experience is essential to understanding the spirituality of Pentecostals, and thus its worship.<sup>111</sup>

In other words, the major contribution of Pentecostalism and Charismatic Movements to the *oikumene* has been the introduction of

<sup>104</sup> McGRATH *Christian Theology*, p. 240.

<sup>105</sup> E.g. LEE, *Pneumatological Ecclesiology*, pp. 2, 263.

<sup>106</sup> See RUSSELL J. SPITTLER, "Suggested Areas for Further Research in Pentecostal Studies," *PNEUMA: The Journal of the Society for Pentecostal Studies* 5:2, 1984, pp. 39-56.

<sup>107</sup> See e.g. WALTER J. HOLLENWEGER, "The Critical Tradition of Pentecostalism," *Journal of Pentecostal Theology* 1, 1992, 7-17.

<sup>108</sup> JON RUTHVEN, *On the Cessation of the Charismata: The Protestant Polemic on Postbiblical Miracles* (Sheffield: Sheffield Academic Press, 1993), p. 14.

<sup>109</sup> VINSON J. SYNAN, "Pentecostalism: Varieties and Contributions," *PNEUMA: The Journal of the Society for Pentecostal Studies* 8:2, 1986, p. 36.

<sup>110</sup> SYNAN, "Pentecostalism," p. 37: "Historically, this is the major point made by Pentecostalism and remains the greatest accomplishment of the movement. All other contributions have been minor in comparison to this one."

<sup>111</sup> For Pentecostal spirituality, see: DANIEL E. ALBRECHT, "Pentecostal Spirituality: Looking through the Lens of Ritual," *PNEUMA: The Journal of the Society for Pentecostal Studies* 14:2, 1992, pp. 107-125; RUSSELL J. SPITTLE, "Spirituality, Pentecostal and Charismatic," in *Dictionary of Pentecostal and Charismatic Movements*, pp. 804-809; WALTER J. HOLLENWEGER, "After Twenty Years' Research on Pentecostalism," *International Review of Missions* 75, January 1986, pp. 3-12. The major monograph on theological interpretation of Pentecostal experience and spirituality is STEVEN J. LAND, *Pentecostal Spirituality. A Passion for the Kingdom* (Sheffield: Sheffield Academic Press, 1993).

charismatic, enthusiastic spirituality with a view of reviving the NT-type of Christianity.<sup>112</sup> The irony of our day is that most ecumenical theologians are still completely unaware of this. What other contribution to pneumatology would be more valuable than this, especially, when the prospects of the Christian church in the future lie in the expansion of nonwestern oral cultures rather than the Western academy?<sup>113</sup>

But notwithstanding the Pentecostal emphasis on living out spirituality rather than writing theological treatises, the younger generation of Pentecostals now — and Charismatic Christians, especially Catholics, since the beginning of the Renewal — have also started to develop distinctively Pentecostal pneumatology and theology.<sup>114</sup>

One of the most studied topics has been the Pentecostal/Charismatic distinctive, the baptism in the Holy Spirit,<sup>115</sup> with accent on speaking in tongues.<sup>116</sup> The topic has produced a manifold ecumenical exchange between Pentecostal theologians and exegetes and systematicians of other persuasions. James D.G. Dunn's classic *Baptism in the Holy Spirit*<sup>117</sup> has invited numerous responses from Pentecostal and Charismatic theologians.<sup>118</sup> Ecumenically the most far reaching study

<sup>112</sup> This was explicitly acknowledged in Canberra 1991: "The development of the Pentecostal movement has profoundly influenced the life and worship of many churches related to the WCC." *Signs of the Spirit*, p. 107.

<sup>113</sup> For an insightful treatment of a distinctive Pentecostal pneumatology worldwide, and its ecumenical contributions, see HOLLENWEGER, *Pentecostalism*, pp. 218ff.

<sup>114</sup> The best windows to the emerging Pentecostal and Charismatic theologizing are several journals: *PNEUMA: The Journal of the Society for Pentecostal Studies* (published by the leading Pentecostal academic society, Society for Pentecostal Studies), *EPTA-Bulletin*, *The Journal of the European Pentecostal Theological Society*, *Journal of Pentecostal Theology* (published by the Sheffield Academic Press, England), *The Asian Journal of Pentecostal Studies*, etc.

<sup>115</sup> A basic guide, with representative bibliography, is LEDERLE, *Interpretations*.

<sup>116</sup> Various aspects of the distinctive Pentecostal view (not followed by the majority of Charismatics in other churches) of Spirit-Baptism with the "initial evidence" of speaking in tongues, is discussed *pro* and *con* in the collection of essays, *Initial Evidence. Historical and Biblical Perspectives on the Pentecostal Doctrine of Spirit Baptism*, ed. GARY B. MCGEE (Peabody, MA: Hendrickson, 1991).

<sup>117</sup> With the subtitle, *A Re-examination of the New Testament Teaching of the Spirit in Relation to Pentecostalism Today* (London: SCM Press, 1970). DUNN's appraisal of Pentecostal theology, even with his critique, is much more sympathetic than the approach of DALE BRUNER, *A Theology of the Holy Spirit: The Pentecostal Experience and the New Testament* (Grand Rapids, MI: Eerdmans, 1970).

<sup>118</sup> E.g. HAROLD, *Spirit-Baptism: A Pentecostal Alternative* (Lanham, MD: University Press of America, 1983); ROGER STRONSTADT, *The Charismatic Theology of St. Luke* (Peabody, MA: Hendrickson, 1984); R.P. MENZIES, *The Development of Early Christian Pneumatology with Special Reference to Luke Acts* (Sheffield: Sheffield Academic Press, 1991), among others. *The Journal of Pentecostal Theology* (vol. 3, 1993) was devoted totally to dialogue between Dunn and his respondents.



has been one initiated by the Catholic-Pentecostal dialogue: the Catholic co-chair Kilian McDonnell, O.S.B., collaborated with the NT-exegete George Montague on the monograph *Spirit-Baptism and Christian Initiation in the First Eight Centuries*<sup>119</sup>. The book argues that during the first centuries of Christendom, baptism in the Holy Spirit was expected to be a normative part of Christian initiation (baptism, Eucharist, confirmation) with accompanying spiritual manifestations, like speaking in tongues, prophecy, etc.<sup>120</sup>

Interestingly enough the appearance of Jürgen Moltmann's *Spirit of Life* has drawn considerable ecumenical exchange between Moltmann and Pentecostal/Charismatic theologians.<sup>121</sup> In fact, Moltmann has been one of the first pneumatologists of international caliber to be engaged in a rather extensive dialogue with Pentecostals/Charismatics. His appearance in the largest Charismatic theological conference at Brighton 1991 (Theological Forum of the International Charismatic Consultation on World Evangelization) opened some limited exchange between continental theologians and their Pentecostal partners.<sup>122</sup>

This was followed by the devotion of the 1996 (vol. 3) *Concilium* issue, edited by Moltmann and Karl-Josef Kuschel, to the topic, "Pentecostal Movements as Ecumenical Challenge," with articles by Pentecostal, Charismatic, Catholic, Orthodox and Protestant theologians. Another recent author of major pneumatology, Michael Welker, has also engaged in dialogue with Pentecostals,<sup>123</sup> as has his compatriot, the NT-exegete Eduard Schweizer.<sup>124</sup>

These few examples mainly from Western ways of doing Pentecostal theology do not do full justice to the Pentecostal movement world-

<sup>119</sup> Collegeville, MN: The Liturgical Press, 1991.

<sup>120</sup> For an ingenious attempt to try to integrate the Pentecostal (non-sacramental) and sacramental (Catholic and other sacramental traditions) approaches to Spirit-baptism is offered by a Pentecostal theologian from Hong Kong, TAK-MING CHEUNG, "Understandings of Spirit-Baptism," *Journal of Pentecostal Theology* 8, 1996, pp. 115-128.

<sup>121</sup> The whole issue of the *Journal of Pentecostal Theology* (vol. 4, 1994) was devoted to the discussion between Moltmann and his respondents who represented every continent.

<sup>122</sup> The proceedings of the theological forum are collected (including Moltmann's key-note address with responses) in *All Together in One Place. Theological Papers from the Brighton Conference on World Evangelization*, ed. HAROLD D. HUNTER and PETER D. HOCKEN (Sheffield: Sheffield Academic Press, 1992).

<sup>123</sup> FRANK MACCHIA, "Discerning the Spirit of Life: A Review of *God the Spirit* by Michael Welker," *Journal of Pentecostal Theology* 10, 1997, 3-28; MICHAEL WELKER, "Spirit Topics: Trinity, Personhood, Mystery and Tongues," *ibid.* pp. 29-34.

<sup>124</sup> EDUARD SCHWEIZER, "A Very Helpful Challenge: Gordon Fee's *God's Empowering Presence*," *Journal of Pentecostal Theology* 8, pp. 7-21.

wide. Distinctively intercultural Pentecostal/Charismatic theologies are emerging in Africa,<sup>125</sup> Asia,<sup>126</sup> Latin America,<sup>127</sup> and elsewhere.<sup>128</sup>

The WCC has shown some limited interest to dialogue with Pentecostals in developing a more conciliar, contextual pneumatology. A major monograph was produced in 1981 as a result of a consultation, titled *The Church is Charismatic*<sup>129</sup>. It was edited by W.J. Hollenweger and Lutheran Arnold Bittlinger, who has distinguished himself as a Charismatic theologian.<sup>130</sup> Theologically and ecumenically, perhaps the most pregnant contribution is that of Hollenweger, who outlines three perspectives to the Spirit: ecclesiological, where the Church is seen as “social experience of God,”; cosmological, where the Spirit creates renewal of creation, healing of social relations, and bodily healing; and sacramental, where the Spirit is given to believers to effect conversion and power for holy living.<sup>131</sup>

The Canberra WCC-Assembly ( 1991 ) was the first to pay specific attention to the contribution of Pentecostals both in liturgy and theologizing about the Spirit. It recommended to its member churches an open attitude towards the Pentecostals and Charismatics and urged them to dialogue with this enthusiastic type of Christianity: “Insofar as they [Pentecostals and Charismatics] emphasize the charisms of the Spirit described in the New Testament and represent a discovery of the ministry of healing, they are valid expressions of Christian living. They also represent a commitment to strong faith and fellowship, increased spontane-

<sup>125</sup> M.L. DANEEL, “African Independent Church Pneumatology and the Salvation of all Creation,” in *All Together in One Place*, pp. 96-126; HOLLENWEGER, *Pentecostalism*, pp. 54ff. (on Kimbanguists in Zaire).

<sup>126</sup> BOO-WONG YOO, “Response to Korean Shamanism by the Pentecostal Church,” *International Review of Mission* 75:297, Jan. 1986, pp. 70-75, and *ibid*, *Korean Pentecostalism: Its History and Theology*. Studies in the Intercultural Theology of Christianity 52 (Frankfurt: Peter Lang, 1991), relevant sections; see also HOLLENWEGER, *Pentecostalism*, pp. 99ff.

<sup>127</sup> See HOLLENWEGER, *Pentecostalism*, pp. 81ff. (on contextual Pentecostalism in Mexico, with representative original sources).

<sup>128</sup> Representative case-studies are included in WALTER J. HOLLENWEGER, *Pentecostal Between Black and White. Five Case Studies on Pentecost and Politics* (Belfast: Christian Journals, 1974; also in German).

<sup>129</sup> *Renewal and Congregational Life*. (Geneva: WCC, 1981).

<sup>130</sup> See A. BITTLINGER, *Papst und Pfingstler: Der römische katholische-pfingstliche Dialoge und seine ökumenische Relevanz*. Studien zur interkulturellen Geschichte des Christentums 16 (Frankfurt am Main: Peter Lang, 1978).

<sup>131</sup> W.J. HOLLENWEGER, “Towards a Church Renewed and United in the Spirit,” in *The Church is Charismatic*, ed. ARNOLD BITTLINGER. *Renewal and Congregational Life* (Geneva: WCC, 1981), pp. 21ff.

ity, openness and freedom among worshippers, all of them leading to greater participation in the life of the churches.”<sup>132</sup>

***Instead of Conclusions: What are the Prospects for a Truly Pneumatological Ecumenical Approach?***

Our descriptive survey of a pneumatological perspective in major theological traditions, with a view to ecumenical potential, has revealed some key principles for further analysis and development:

First of all, the resurgence of pneumatology in every theological corner is a fact of enormous ecumenical significance. Seldom, if ever, has there been in the history of theology, in such a short period of time and to such a broad extent, a more distinctive *conciliar* development than the new enthusiasm concerning the Spirit of God. One suspects that behind this enthusiasm is something more than just a passing fascination with the “latest fashion”. The emergence of pneumatology has implications, not just for the subject matter of theology, but also for its method, boundaries, expressions, and so on.

Second, it seems that two factors have been the primary catalysts in contributing to this development: on the one hand, the voice of Eastern Orthodox theology, especially after its inclusion in the WCC; on the other hand, the dramatic growth and spread of Pentecostalism and Charismatic Movements. To these must be added the reformulation of the theological agenda in Catholic theology as a result of Vatican II. Academic theology, operating up until our days mainly from a Western/European perspective, must now reflect on this truly catholic agenda.

Third, the resurgence of pneumatology operates on two levels: in spirituality, which is the main focus of Pentecostal/Charismatic Christianity but also to a large measure that of Eastern Orthodoxy, and in theology, with an increasing literature on the topic. Hardly any other theological topic has such a potential for integrating spirituality and discursive theologizing; and there is much in the Western academic enterprise to be learned from both Pentecostals and Third World Christians. The hegemony of one-sided Western theologizing, notwithstanding its massive accomplishments, has to give way to a more comprehensive, inter-

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<sup>132</sup> *Signs of the Spirit*, pp. 107; for a complete listing of recommendations, see pp. 107-108; 250-251.

cultural theologizing where the whole life, not just intellectualism, comes to bear to our thinking and living about God. A true *ecumenical* theologizing can never be a possession of one segment of world Christianity only; especially of that segment which is diminishing while non-western regions are growing fastly.

Fourth, the existing ecumenical “models”, especially the *koinonia*-theology with its leaning towards the role of the Spirit in the search for Christian unity, have to be reworked in order to include the critical role of pneumatology. A truly Trinitarian approach to ecumenism always emphasizes the role of the Spirit since — as Eastern theologians have taught us — we can never know the “essence” of God, only his “energies”, or the “economy” of the Spirit.

Fifth, it has always been the belief of the church catholic that the Spirit is the uniting factor, not only *ad intra* Trinity but also between Christians, who have been born and empowered with the same Spirit of God. The renaissance of pneumatology bears testimony to what the church has always believed since the time of the first apostles. In the New Delhi WCC Assembly (1961) an ecumenically fruitful statement pointed to the importance of a pneumatological perspective in the search for Christian unity: “We believe that the unity which is both God’s will and his gift to his church is being made visible as all in each place... are brought by the Holy Spirit into one fully committed fellowship.”<sup>133</sup>

Sixth, consequently, pneumatology can not be seen as a separate article in theology in general, or in ecumenical theology, but as overarching principle of unity, anchored in a Trinitarian vision of the unity of all God’s people. The *lacuna* of much theologizing about the Holy Spirit, especially in the West, has been either practical subordination of the Spirit, or, even more often, the treatment of the “doctrine of the Spirit” in a separate theological *locus* rather than as an integrating theme permeating and governing all we say about God and his works. In this new kind of holistic view prospects emerge for a new “ecumenical model”. In the words of Orthodox ecumenist Boris Bobrinskoy,

The theology of the Holy Spirit, or pneumatology, is not so much one specific chapter of Christian theology as an essential dimension of every

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<sup>133</sup> Report on section on unity, para. 2, quoted in H.E. FEY, ed., *The Ecumenical Advance: A History of the Ecumenical Movement*, vol. 2: 1948-1968 (Geneva: WCC, 1986), p. 4.

theological view of the church and of its spirituality and liturgical and sacramental life. The Holy Spirit...is first and foremost the Spirit we invoke, the Spirit who presides over the upbuilding and renewal of the church, the Spirit who infuses everyone that comes into the world with the light of Christ.<sup>134</sup>

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### RÉSUMÉ

Dans le passé la théologie oecuménique n'a pas fait fort attention au rôle du Saint Esprit en ses efforts en vue de l'union chrétienne. L'emphasis a été mise plutôt sur les «modèles oécuméniques». Aujourd'hui il existe une recrudescence de pneumatologie en toutes matières touchant à la théologie.

Sans doute, la théologie orientale a été à l'avant-garde de la doctrine de l'Esprit Saint et de ses implications en d'autres matières théologiques. Une emphasis pneumatologique dans les théologies issues du Conseil oecuménique des Eglises est un phénomène courant; l'événement-clé a été bien sûr l'Assemblée Générale de 1991. L'Eglise catholique romaine s'est ouverte à une concentration notable sur le Saint Esprit après le Second Concile du Vatican, donnant lieu à des développements ecclésiologiques et sacramentaires qui ont tracé de nouvelles pistes.

L'éclatement des mouvements pentecostaux et charismatiques en notre siècle a aidé les autres Eglises à devenir plus sensibles aux dimensions expérimentales de la pneumatologie.

Le renouveau oecuménique de la doctrine du Saint Esprit a des implications, non seulement pour l'unité chrétienne, mais aussi pour la méthode théologique et la spiritualité.

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<sup>134</sup> BORIS BOBRINSKOY, "Holy Spirit," *Dictionary of the Ecumenical Movement*, pp. 470-473.